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Methods for secured capacitor bank control of series-compensated transmission line

Abstract

Power systems, such as transmission systems, may comprise a series capacitor bank (SCB) to provide series compensation on a power line. The SCB may be electrically inserted into the power line or bypassed according to commands sent by remote systems. Such commands may be compromised in a cyberattack to cause deteriorated conditions and instability in the power system. Thus, according to an embodiment, a protection layer is provided in an SCB station to intercept commands prior to execution, assess the consistency of the commands with a physical state of the power system, and either allow or block the commands based on the assessment, to thereby protect the SCB from cyberattacks.

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Background/Summary

BACKGROUND

Field of the Invention

(1) The embodiments described herein are generally directed to control in a power system, and, more particularly, to secure control of a series capacitor bank (SCB) in a power line.

Description of the Related Art

(2) A series capacitor bank (SCB) comprises a plurality of capacitors, electrically connected in series with each other to store electrical energy. SCBs are incorporated into alternating current (AC) power lines to improve the steady-state performance and dynamic characteristics of a power system. The maximum active power that is transferable over a power line is inversely proportional to the series inductive reactance of the power line. Thus, by compensating the series inductive reactance of the power line, typically between 25% and 70%, using an SCB, an electrically shorter power line can be realized and higher active power transfer and improved system dynamic performance can be achieved. In general, the main benefits of applying series compensation in transmission power systems include enhanced system dynamic stability, desirable load division among parallel lines, improved voltage regulation and reactive power balance, and reduced transmission losses.

(3) Security against malicious control of SCBs is deemed critical. An attacker may gain access to the communication channels of the power system and initiate unauthorized control commands or alter control commands to manipulate SCB positions. For example, an attacker may issue malicious control commands to manipulate the SCB positions under normal conditions, block or compromise the control commands under abnormal (e.g., emergency) conditions, generate successive bypass and insertion commands to SCBs, and/or the like. Unauthorized or altered control commands may cause overloading on power lines, voltage violations, inter-area oscillations, reduced stability margin against contingencies, risk of system instability, and the like.

SUMMARY

(4) It would be advantageous to protect a series capacitor bank (SCB) against malicious control. It would also be desirable to intercept commands prior to execution, assess them based on their consistency with a physical state of the power system, and either block or allow the command based on that assessment. It would be further advantageous to assess consistency based on the presence or absence of a line fault or other system disturbance, as well as to prevent successive switching of the SCB's state. Accordingly, to address one or more of these concerns, systems, methods, and non-transitory computer-readable media are disclosed for secure control of a series capacitor bank (SCB) in a power line.

(5) In an embodiment, a method comprises using at least one hardware processor, within a controller of a series capacitor bank (SCB) station, to: receive a remote control signal from a system that is external to the SCB station, wherein the remote control signal represents a command to either electrically insert the SCB into a power line within a power system or bypass the SCB; assess whether or not the command is consistent with a physical state of the power system; when the command is inconsistent with the physical state of the power system, block execution of the command by the controller; and, when the command is consistent with the physical state of the

power system, allow execution of the command by the controller.

(6) The method may further comprise using the at least one hardware processor to, when the command is inconsistent with the physical state of the power system, initiate an alert to one or more recipients.

(7) The method may further comprise using the at least one hardware processor to execute a line-fault detection (LFD) function that determines whether or not a line fault exists within a detection zone, wherein assessing whether or not the command is consistent with the physical state of the power system comprises: determining that the command is inconsistent with the physical state of the power system when the command is to bypass the SCB and is received while no line fault is determined to exist within the detection zone by the LFD function; and determining that the command is consistent with the physical state of the power system when the command is to bypass the SCB and is received while the line fault is determined to exist within the detection zone by the LFD function. The remote control signal may be received from a line protection system.

(8) The method may further comprise using the at least one hardware processor to execute a system disturbance detection (SDD) function that determines whether or not a system disturbance exists within the power system, wherein assessing whether or not the command is consistent with the physical state of the power system comprises determining whether or not the command is consistent based on an existence or non-existence of the system disturbance, as determined by the SDD function, within a time window around receipt of the remote control signal.

(9) The system disturbance may comprise an emergency power transfer, wherein determining whether or not the command is consistent based on the existence or non-existence of the system disturbance comprises: determining that the command is inconsistent when the command is to insert the SCB and no emergency power transfer is determined to exist by the SDD function within the time window; and determining that the command is consistent when the command is to insert the SCB and the emergency power transfer is determined to exist by the SDD function within the time window.

(10) The system disturbance may comprise a frequency disturbance, wherein determining whether or not the command is consistent based on the existence or non-existence of the system disturbance comprises: determining that the command is inconsistent when the command is to one of insert the SCB or bypass the SCB and no frequency disturbance is determined to exist by the SDD function within the time window; and determining that the command is consistent when the command is to the other one of insert the SCB or bypass the SCB and the frequency disturbance is determined to exist by the SDD function within the time window.

(11) The system disturbance may comprise an abnormal voltage, wherein determining whether or not the command is consistent based on the existence or non-existence of the system disturbance comprises: determining that the command is inconsistent when the command is to one of insert the SCB or bypass the SCB and no abnormal voltage is determined to exist by the SDD function within the time window; and determining that the command is consistent when the command is to the other one of insert the SCB or bypass the SCB and the abnormal voltage is determined to exist by the SDD function within the time window.

(12) The remote control signal may be received from a remedial action schemes (RAS) system, an energy management system (EMS), or a wide-area monitoring, protection, and control (WAMPAC) system.

(13) Assessing whether or not the command is consistent with the physical state of the power system may comprise: determining that the command is inconsistent with the physical state of the power system, when either the command is to insert the SCB and a present load of the transmission line is below a first threshold, or the command is to bypass the SCB and the present load of the transmission line exceeds a second threshold; and determining that the command is consistent with the physical state of the power system, when either the command is to insert the SCB and the present load of the transmission line exceeds the second threshold, or the command is to bypass the

SCB and the present load of the transmission line is below the first threshold.

(14) Assessing whether or not the command is consistent with the physical state of the power system may comprise determining that the command is inconsistent with the physical state of the power system when either: the command is to insert the SCB and is received within a time window from execution of a prior command to bypass the SCB; or the command is to bypass the SCB and is received within the time window from execution of a prior command to insert the SCB.

(15) The method may further comprise using the at least one hardware processor to execute two or more of: a line fault detection (LFD) function that determines whether or not a line fault exists on the transmission line; a system disturbance detection (SDD) function that determines whether or not a system disturbance exists within the power system; or an interlocking schemes (IS) function that determines one or both of a load condition of the transmission line or whether or not a prior command has been executed within a time window preceding receipt of the remote control signal; wherein assessing whether or not the command is consistent with the physical state of the power system comprises executing logic that utilizes the determination by each of the two or more of the LFD function, the SDD function, and the IS function to determine whether or not the command is consistent with the physical state of the power system. The method may further comprise using the at least one hardware processor to: receive real-time measurements of the power system; and execute the two or more of the LFD function, the SDD function, or the IS function in real time using the real-time measurements as input. The logic may complete execution within 500 milliseconds of receiving the remote control signal.

(16) The method may further comprise using the at least one hardware processor to: receive real-time measurements of the power system; and continually determine the physical state of the power system in real time based on the real-time measurements, wherein the assessment is performed each time a remote control signal is received.

(17) The method may further comprise using the at least one hardware processor to, when execution of the command is allowed, controlling a bypass breaker of the SCB station according to the command. Controlling the bypass breaker may comprise: opening the bypass breaker when the command is to insert the SCB; and closing the bypass breaker when the command is to bypass the SCB.

(18) It should be understood that any of the features in the methods above may be implemented individually or with any subset of the other features in any combination. Thus, to the extent that the appended claims would suggest particular dependencies between features, disclosed embodiments are not limited to these particular dependencies. Rather, any of the features described herein may be combined with any other feature described herein, or implemented without any one or more other features described herein, in any combination of features whatsoever. In addition, any of the methods, described above and elsewhere herein, may be embodied, individually or in any combination, in executable software modules of a processor-based system, such as the controller of an SCB station, and/or in executable instructions stored in a non-transitory computer-readable medium.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The details of the present invention, both as to its structure and operation, may be gleaned in part by study of the accompanying drawings, in which like reference numerals refer to like parts, and in which:

(2) FIG. 1 illustrates a schematic of an example infrastructure in which one or more of the disclosed processes may be implemented, according to an embodiment;

(3) FIG. 2 illustrates an example processing system, by which one or more of the processes

described herein, may be executed, according to an embodiment;

(4) FIG. 3 illustrates a process, which may be implemented by a protection layer of a controller of an SCB station, according to an embodiment;

(5) FIG. 4 illustrates examples of the security functions that may be employed by the protection layer, according to an embodiment;

(6) FIGS. 5A and 5B illustrate the status of a power system, before and after a line fault, respectively, according to an example scenario;

(7) FIG. 6 illustrates plots representing the performance of a simulation of the scenario illustrated in FIGS. 5A and 5B, according to an embodiment;

(8) FIGS. 7A and 7B illustrate the status of a power system, before and after an emergency power transfer, respectively, according to an example scenario; and

(9) FIG. 8 illustrates plots representing the performance of a simulation of the scenario illustrated in FIGS. 7A and 7B, according to an embodiment.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(10) In an embodiment, systems, methods, and non-transitory computer-readable media are disclosed for secure control of a series capacitor bank (SCB) in a power line. After reading this description, it will become apparent to one skilled in the art how to implement the invention in various alternative embodiments and alternative applications. However, although various embodiments of the present invention will be described herein, it is understood that these embodiments are presented by way of example and illustration only, and not limitation. As such, this detailed description of various embodiments should not be construed to limit the scope or breadth of the present invention as set forth in the appended claims.

1. System Overview

(11) 1.1. Infrastructure

(12) FIG. 1 illustrates a schematic of an example infrastructure in which one or more of the disclosed processes may be implemented, according to an embodiment. It is generally contemplated that the disclosed embodiments will be performed in a power system **100**, such as a power grid (e.g., at any scale, from a large-scale utility grid to a regional grid). Power system **100** may be any network of electrical components (e.g., power system equipment) configured to generate, store, supply, transmit, distribute, and/or consume electrical power, including, without limitation, power stations configured to produce electricity from combustible fuels (e.g., coal, natural gas, nuclear, etc.) and/or renewable resources (e.g., wind, solar, etc.), transmission systems configured to carry or transmit electricity from sources (e.g., generators, battery energy storage (BES) systems, etc.) to loads, and distribution systems configured to feed supplied electricity to nearby homes, businesses, and/or other establishments. However, disclosed embodiments will primarily be discussed and illustrated herein with respect to a transmission system.

(13) Power system **100** comprises a power line **110**. Power line **110** may be a transmission line that extends between a first substation bus **112** and a second substation bus **114**. However, power line **110** could be any wire or other conductor that conducts electricity through a controllable SCB. Power line **110** may include one or more current measurement devices **116** (e.g., **116A** and **116B**) that measure current in power line **110** and one or more voltage measurement devices (e.g., **118A** and **118B**) that measure voltage in power line **110**. Power line **110** may also include at least one circuit breaker **120**.

(14) Line protection system **130** may receive data reflecting information about power system **100**, including current measurements from at least one current measurement device **116A** and/or voltage measurements from at least one voltage measurement device **118A**. Line protection system **130** may analyze the data in real-time, and control circuit breaker **120** based on the analysis of the data. In particular, line protection system **130** may trip (i.e., open) circuit breaker **120** in order to protect power line **110** when line protection system **130** detects a fault in power line **110** based on analysis of the data. It should be understood that a line fault may be any abnormal electric current in power

line **110**. In a three-phase power line **110**, this includes, without limitation, a line-to-line fault (i.e., a short circuit between two phases of power line **110**), a line-to-ground fault (i.e., a short circuit between one phase of power line **110** and the ground), a double line-to-ground fault (i.e., a short circuit between two phases of power line **110** and the ground), or the like.

(15) Power system **100** may also comprise one or more other control systems **140**, such as a Remedial Action Scheme (RAS) system **142**, a Supervisory Control and Data Acquisition (SCADA)/Energy Management System (EMS) **144**, a Wide-Area Monitoring, Protection, and Control (WAMPAC) system **146**, and/or the like. Each of these systems may receive data, for example, from one or more sensors (e.g., current measurement device(s) **116**, voltage measurement device(s) **118**, etc.) within power system **100**, analyze the measurements, and perform corrective actions when appropriate. For example, an RAS system **142** generally provides automatic mitigation of violations in the performance of power system **100**, other than detecting and isolating faults. Mitigation may include, without limitation, adjusting or tripping power generation, tripping a load, reconfiguring power system **100**, and/or the like. A SCADA/EMS **144** monitors power system **100**, such as a utility grid or regional grid, by acquiring data, and performs high-level supervision and control of power system **100** based on the acquired data and/or in response to user operations. This control may include scheduling power generation, scheduling power consumption, and/or controlling other components of power system **100**. A WAMPAC system **146** is an integrated real-time system that utilizes both wide-area information and local information (e.g., voltage and current phasors, frequency, rate-of-change-of-frequency, etc.) to perform adaptive corrective control and protection actions. It should be understood that any reference herein to a control system **140** may refer to one or a combination of any of RAS system **142**, SCADA/EMS **144**, WAMPAC system **146**, or any other system that may be used to control an SCB.

(16) Power system **100** also comprises an SCB station **150**. An SCB station **150** is any system that includes an SCB, a bypass breaker in parallel with the SCB, and a controller configured to switch the bypass breaker between an open state and a closed state. For example, as illustrated, SCB station **150** comprises an SCB **151** (e.g., the QBank™ offered by Hitachi Energy), which may comprise a group of one or a plurality of capacitors that are electrically connected in series to provide series compensation to power line **110**, as well as a bypass breaker (BB) **152** (e.g., a fast bypass breaker) and a controller **154** (e.g., any of the CQ™ series of capacitor bank controllers offered by Hitachi Energy). Controller **154** comprises a protection layer **155**. SCB station **150** may also comprise a metal oxide varistor (MOV) **156**, discharge equipment **157**, and a forced trigger spark gap **158**. Collectively, MOV **156**, discharge equipment **157**, and forced trigger spark gap **158** may provide overvoltage protection for SCB **151**. SCB station **150** may implement fixed series compensation, thyristor-controlled series compensation, or any flexible alternating current transmission system (FACTS) series compensation.

(17) An SCB station **150**, with a corresponding SCB **151**, may be provided at one point or a plurality of points along power line **110** and at any suitable location(s) along power line **110**. For example, a first SCB station **150** could be provided at or near first substation bus **112** and a second SCB station **150** could be provided at or near second substation bus **114**. Alternatively or additionally, an SCB station **150** may be positioned at or near the middle of power line **110**.

(18) Controller **154** controls bypass breaker **152** to switch between an open state, in which SCB **151** is electrically inserted into power line **110** to provide series compensation to power line **110**, and a closed state, in which SCB **151** is bypassed. Typically, SCB **151** is electrically inserted into power line **110** by opening bypass breaker **152** when power line **110** is under high power transfer conditions, and bypassed by closing bypass breaker **152** under low power transfer conditions. This control may be done manually (e.g., via a SCADA/EMS **144**) or automatically (e.g., by line protection system **130**, RAS system **142**, WAMPAC system **146**, etc.). For example, an operator may provide an input to a graphical user interface of SCADA/EMS **144** to insert or bypass SCB **151**, according to planned operating conditions.

(19) As another example, line protection system **130** may detect a line fault and send a remote control signal to controller **154** to bypass SCB **151**, as well as controlling circuit breaker **120** to open in order to isolate the fault. Fast bypassing of an SCB **151** is one strategy for reducing transient recovery voltage (TRV) in extra high-voltage transmission lines (e.g., 345 kV-765 kV). Transmission lines with high degrees of series compensation have increased TRV levels, which may exceed the capability of circuit breaker **120**. This can lead to damage to circuit breaker **120**, as well as potential damage to other components of power system **100**. For series-compensated transmission lines with potential TRV issues, line protection system **130** will simultaneously send both a line trip signal to circuit breaker **120** and a remote control signal, representing a command to bypass SCB **151**, to SCB controller **154**, whenever line protection system **130** detects a line fault. Given that the speed of bypass breaker **152** (e.g., approximately 5 milliseconds) is faster than the speed of circuit breaker **120** (e.g., approximately 2030 milliseconds), SCB **151** can be bypassed well in advance of circuit breaker **120** opening.

(20) As another example, RAS system **142** may send remote control signals to controller **154** under emergency conditions. Fast bypassing or fast insertion of SCB **151** on critical transmission lines has been implemented as part of RAS actions in some regional power grids to mitigate potential risks of system instability, resulting from major generation or transmission outages. For instance, RAS system **142** may detect a critical transmission outage and send a remote control signal to controller **154** to insert SCB **151**.

(21) In either case, the controlling system **130** or **140** may send a remote control signal (e.g., via direction communications or via a communication network of power system **100**) to controller **154**. The remote control signal represents a command to either electrically insert SCB **151** into power line **110** or bypass SCB **151**. It should be understood that the remote control signal may comprise an indication to either insert SCB **151** or bypass SCB **151** or may comprise an indication to switch the state of bypass breaker **152** between the open state and the closed state.

(22) In an embodiment, every remote control signal that is received by controller **154** is processed by protection layer **155** prior to execution of the command. Protection layer **155** may intercept each command and implement the disclosed processes to either allow execution of the command or block execution of the command. When execution of the command is allowed by protection layer **155**, controller **154** may send a signal to bypass breaker **152** representing an instruction to either open or close, according to the command. When execution of the command is blocked by protection layer **155**, controller **154** may issue an alert and either discard or delay the command (e.g., until an operator or other system confirms the command)

(23) Controller **154** may receive data reflecting information about power system **100**, including current measurements from at least one current measurement device **116B** and/or voltage measurements from at least one voltage measurement device **118B**. This data may be used by functions, implemented in controller **154**, to control one or more features of SCB station **150**. Of particular relevance to the present disclosure, this data may be used by protection layer **155** to inform the disclosed process for allowing or blocking execution of the command in a remote control signal.

(24) 1.2. Example Processing Device

(25) FIG. 2 is a block diagram illustrating an example wired or wireless system **200** that may be used in connection with various embodiments described herein. For example, system **200** may be used as or in conjunction with one or more of the functions, processes, or methods (e.g., to store and/or execute the software) described herein, and may represent components of controller **154**, line protection system **130**, control system(s) **140**, and/or other processing devices described herein. System **200** can be a server or any conventional personal computer, or any other processor-enabled device that is capable of wired or wireless data communication. Other computer systems and/or architectures may be also used, as will be clear to those skilled in the art.

(26) System **200** preferably includes one or more processors **210**. Processor(s) **210** may comprise a

central processing unit (CPU). Additional processors may be provided, such as a graphics processing unit (GPU), an auxiliary processor to manage input/output, an auxiliary processor to perform floating-point mathematical operations, a special-purpose microprocessor having an architecture suitable for fast execution of signal-processing algorithms (e.g., digital-signal processor), a slave processor subordinate to the main processing system (e.g., back-end processor), an additional microprocessor or controller for dual or multiple processor systems, and/or a coprocessor. Such auxiliary processors may be discrete processors or may be integrated with processor **210**. Examples of processors which may be used with system **200** include, without limitation, any of the processors (e.g., Pentium™, Core i7™, Xeon™, etc.) available from Intel Corporation of Santa Clara, California, any of the processors available from Advanced Micro Devices, Incorporated (AMD) of Santa Clara, California, any of the processors (e.g., A series, M series, etc.) available from Apple Inc. of Cupertino, any of the processors (e.g., Exynos™) available from Samsung Electronics Co., Ltd., of Seoul, South Korea, any of the processors available from NXP Semiconductors N.V. of Eindhoven, Netherlands, and/or the like.

(27) Processor **210** is preferably connected to a communication bus **205**. Communication bus **205** may include a data channel for facilitating information transfer between storage and other peripheral components of system **200**. Furthermore, communication bus **205** may provide a set of signals used for communication with processor **210**, including a data bus, address bus, and/or control bus (not shown). Communication bus **205** may comprise any standard or non-standard bus architecture such as, for example, bus architectures compliant with industry standard architecture (ISA), extended industry standard architecture (EISA), Micro Channel Architecture (MCA), peripheral component interconnect (PCI) local bus, standards promulgated by the Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers (IEEE) including IEEE 488 general-purpose interface bus (GPIB), IEEE 696/S-100, and/or the like.

(28) System **200** preferably includes a main memory **215** and may also include a secondary memory **220**. Main memory **215** provides storage of instructions and data for programs executing on processor **210**, such as any of the software discussed herein. It should be understood that programs stored in the memory and executed by processor **210** may be written and/or compiled according to any suitable language, including without limitation C/C++, Java, JavaScript, Perl, Visual Basic, .NET, and the like. Main memory **215** is typically semiconductor-based memory such as dynamic random access memory (DRAM) and/or static random access memory (SRAM). Other semiconductor-based memory types include, for example, synchronous dynamic random access memory (SDRAM), Rambus dynamic random access memory (RDRAM), ferroelectric random access memory (FRAM), and the like, including read only memory (ROM).

(29) Secondary memory **220** is a non-transitory computer-readable medium having computer-executable code (e.g., any of the software disclosed herein, such as protection layer **155**) and/or other data stored thereon. The computer software or data stored on secondary memory **220** is read into main memory **215** for execution by processor **210**. Secondary memory **220** may include, for example, semiconductor-based memory, such as programmable read-only memory (PROM), erasable programmable read-only memory (EPROM), electrically erasable read-only memory (EEPROM), and flash memory (block-oriented memory similar to EEPROM).

(30) Secondary memory **220** may optionally include an internal medium **225** and/or a removable medium **230**. Removable medium **230** is read from and/or written to in any well-known manner. Removable storage medium **230** may be, for example, a magnetic tape drive, a compact disc (CD) drive, a digital versatile disc (DVD) drive, other optical drive, a flash memory drive, and/or the like.

(31) In alternative embodiments, secondary memory **220** may include other similar means for allowing computer programs or other data or instructions to be loaded into system **200**. Such means may include, for example, a communication interface **240**, which allows software and data to be transferred from external storage medium **245** to system **200**. Examples of external storage medium

245 include an external hard disk drive, an external optical drive, an external magneto-optical drive, and/or the like.

(32) As mentioned above, system **200** may include a communication interface **240**. Communication interface **240** allows software and data to be transferred between system **200** and external devices, networks, or other information sources. For example, computer software or executable code may be transferred to system **200** from a network server via communication interface **240**. Examples of communication interface **240** include a built-in network adapter, network interface card (NIC), Personal Computer Memory Card International Association (PCMCIA) network card, card bus network adapter, wireless network adapter, Universal Serial Bus (USB) network adapter, modem, a wireless data card, a communications port, an infrared interface, an IEEE 1394 fire-wire, and any other device capable of interfacing system **200** with a network or another computing device. Communication interface **240** preferably implements industry-promulgated protocol standards, such as Ethernet IEEE 802 standards, Fiber Channel, digital subscriber line (DSL), asynchronous digital subscriber line (ADSL), frame relay, asynchronous transfer mode (ATM), integrated digital services network (ISDN), personal communications services (PCS), transmission control protocol/Internet protocol (TCP/IP), serial line Internet protocol/point to point protocol (SLIP/PPP), and so on, but may also implement customized or non-standard interface protocols as well.

(33) Software and data transferred via communication interface **240** are generally in the form of electrical communication signals **255**. These signals **255** may be provided to communication interface **240** via a communication channel **250**. In an embodiment, communication channel **250** may be a wired or wireless network, or any variety of other communication links. Communication channel **250** carries signals **255** and can be implemented using a variety of wired or wireless communication means including wire or cable, fiber optics, conventional phone line, cellular phone link, wireless data communication link, radio frequency (“RF”) link, or infrared link, just to name a few.

(34) Computer-executable code (e.g., computer programs, such as the disclosed protection layer **155**) is stored in main memory **215** and/or secondary memory **220**. Computer-executable code can also be received via communication interface **240** and stored in main memory **215** and/or secondary memory **220**. Such computer programs, when executed, enable system **200** to perform the various functions of the disclosed embodiments as described elsewhere herein.

(35) In this description, the term “computer-readable medium” is used to refer to any non-transitory computer-readable storage media used to provide computer-executable code and/or other data to or within system **200**. Examples of such media include main memory **215**, secondary memory **220** (including internal memory **225** and/or removable medium **230**), external storage medium **245**, and any peripheral device communicatively coupled with communication interface **240** (including a network information server or other network device). These non-transitory computer-readable media are means for providing software and/or other data to system **200**.

(36) In an embodiment that is implemented using software, the software may be stored on a computer-readable medium and loaded into system **200** by way of removable medium **230**, I/O interface **235**, or communication interface **240**. In such an embodiment, the software is loaded into system **200** in the form of electrical communication signals **255**. The software, when executed by processor **210**, preferably causes processor **210** to perform one or more of the processes and functions described elsewhere herein.

(37) In an embodiment, I/O interface **235** provides an interface between one or more components of system **200** and one or more input and/or output devices. Example input devices include, without limitation, sensors, keyboards, touch screens or other touch-sensitive devices, cameras, biometric sensing devices, computer mice, trackballs, pen-based pointing devices, and/or the like. Examples of output devices include, without limitation, other processing devices, cathode ray tubes (CRTs), plasma displays, light-emitting diode (LED) displays, liquid crystal displays (LCDs), printers,

vacuum fluorescent displays (VFDs), surface-conduction electron-emitter displays (SEDs), field emission displays (FEDs), and/or the like. In some cases, an input and output device may be combined, such as in the case of a touch panel display (e.g., in a smartphone, tablet, or other mobile device).

(38) System **200** may also include optional wireless communication components that facilitate wireless communication over a voice network and/or a data network. The wireless communication components comprise an antenna system **270**, a radio system **265**, and a baseband system **260**. In system **200**, radio frequency (RF) signals are transmitted and received over the air by antenna system **270** under the management of radio system **265**.

(39) In an embodiment, antenna system **270** may comprise one or more antennae and one or more multiplexors (not shown) that perform a switching function to provide antenna system **270** with transmit and receive signal paths. In the receive path, received RF signals can be coupled from a multiplexor to a low noise amplifier (not shown) that amplifies the received RF signal and sends the amplified signal to radio system **265**.

(40) In an alternative embodiment, radio system **265** may comprise one or more radios that are configured to communicate over various frequencies. In an embodiment, radio system **265** may combine a demodulator (not shown) and modulator (not shown) in one integrated circuit (IC). The demodulator and modulator can also be separate components. In the incoming path, the demodulator strips away the RF carrier signal leaving a baseband receive audio signal, which is sent from radio system **265** to baseband system **260**.

(41) Baseband system **260** is also communicatively coupled with processor(s) **210**. Processor(s) **210** may have access to data storage areas **215** and **220**. Processor(s) **210** are preferably configured to execute instructions (i.e., computer programs, such as the disclosed protection layer **155**) that can be stored in main memory **215** or secondary memory **220**. Computer programs can also be received from baseband processor **260** and stored in main memory **210** or in secondary memory **220**, or executed upon receipt. Such computer programs, when executed, can enable system **200** to perform the various functions of the disclosed embodiments.

2. Process Overview

(42) Embodiments of processes for secure control of an SCB in a power line will now be described in detail. It should be understood that the described processes may be embodied in one or more software modules that are executed by one or more hardware processors (e.g., processor **210**) of controller **154**, for example, as protection layer **155**, stored in a memory (e.g., main memory **215**) of controller **154**. The described processes may be implemented as instructions represented in source code, object code, and/or machine code. These instructions may be executed directly by hardware processor(s) **210** of controller **154**, or alternatively, may be executed by a virtual machine operating between the object code and hardware processor(s) **210** of controller **154**.

(43) Alternatively, the described processes may be implemented as a hardware component (e.g., general-purpose processor, integrated circuit (IC), application-specific integrated circuit (ASIC), digital signal processor (DSP), field-programmable gate array (FPGA) or other programmable logic device, discrete gate or transistor logic, etc.), combination of hardware components, or combination of hardware and software components. To clearly illustrate the interchangeability of hardware and software, various illustrative components, blocks, modules, circuits, and steps are described herein generally in terms of their functionality. Whether such functionality is implemented as hardware or software depends upon the particular application and design constraints imposed on the overall system. Skilled persons can implement the described functionality in varying ways for each particular application, but such implementation decisions should not be interpreted as causing a departure from the scope of the invention. In addition, the grouping of functions within a component, block, module, circuit, or step is for ease of description. Specific functions or steps can be moved from one component, block, module, circuit, or step to another without departing from the invention.

(44) Furthermore, while the processes, described herein, are illustrated with a certain arrangement and ordering of subprocesses, each process may be implemented with fewer, more, or different subprocesses and a different arrangement and/or ordering of subprocesses. In addition, it should be understood that any subprocess, which does not depend on the completion of another subprocess, may be executed before, after, or in parallel with that other independent subprocess, even if the subprocesses are described or illustrated in a particular order.

(45) 2.1. Protection Layer

(46) FIG. 3 illustrates a process **300**, which may be implemented by protection layer **155** of controller **154** of each SCB station **150**, according to an embodiment. Process **300** may be initiated when controller **154** is booted and execute for as long as controller **154** remains active. Process **300** may execute in the background of controller **154** to evaluate every command that is received by controller **154** in a remote control signal from a line protection system **130** and/or other control system **140**, before that command can be executed by controller **154**. Process **300** is designed to prevent cyberattacks directed at remote control signals sent by remote systems, such as line protection system **130** and other control systems **140**, that are external to SCB station **150**. Such cyberattacks may comprise altering legitimate remote control signals prior to their reception by controller **154** and/or sending false remote control signals to controller **154**.

(47) Process **300** may comprise two threads, which may execute independently of each other. A first thread comprises subprocesses **310** and **320** to collect data about the dynamic conditions of power system **100**. A second thread comprises subprocesses **330-380** to evaluate each command that is received by controller **154**.

(48) In subprocess **310**, process **300** monitors data related to power system **100**. For example, this data may comprise current measurements acquired from current measurement device(s) **116**, voltage measurements acquired from voltage measurement device(s) **118**, and/or other local metrics acquired from other sensors and/or derived from the sensors. This data may be monitored at a high sampling rate in real time. As used herein, the term “real time” or “real-time” encompasses both a simultaneous occurrence and an occurrence that is delayed in time due to ordinary latencies in processing, storage, communications, and/or the like. For as long as no new data are received (i.e., “No” in subprocess **310**), process **300** continues to monitor for new data. When new data are received (i.e., “Yes” in subprocess **310**), process **300** proceeds to subprocess **320**.

(49) In subprocess **320**, new data may be processed according to a sliding window in the range of tens of milliseconds to a few seconds. As the data are processed, process **300** may update the physical state **325** of power system **100**. For example, a representation of physical state **325** of power system **100** may be stored in memory (e.g., main memory **215** and/or secondary memory **220** of controller **154**). Physical state **325** may comprise real-time measurements and/or information derived from the real-time measurements, including, for example, dynamic condition indicators, such as derivatives of line current, incremental line flow changes, grid frequency deviations, voltage phase angle changes, and/or the like, within the sliding window. Controller **154** may continually update the stored representation of physical state **325**, in real time, as new data are received.

(50) In subprocess **330**, process **300** monitors remote control signals received from remote systems, such as line protection system **130** and/or control systems **140** (e.g., RAS system **142**, SCADA/EMS **144**, WAMPAC system **146**, etc.), to identify the commands within those remote control signals. For as long as no new command is received (i.e., “No” in subprocess **330**), process **300** continues to monitor for new commands. Whenever a new command is received (i.e., “Yes” in subprocess **330**), an iteration through the loop formed by subprocesses **340-380** is performed.

(51) In subprocess **340**, process **300** assesses whether or not the command is consistent with physical state **325** of power system **100**. In particular, protection layer **155** may access the representation of physical state **325**, and execute one or a plurality of security functions that are configured to detect an anomaly in physical state **325** and/or otherwise assess physical state **325**.

Protection layer **155** may also execute logic that determines whether or not the command is consistent with physical state **325** based on the output of the security function(s). For example, the logic may apply one or more rules to the command and the output of the security function(s) to assess whether or not the command is consistent with physical state **325**. This consistency assessment is described in greater detail elsewhere herein.

(52) If the result of the assessment in subprocess **340** is that the command is consistent with physical state **325** (i.e., “Yes” in subprocess **350**), the command may be executed in subprocess **360**. Otherwise, if the result of the assessment in subprocess **340** is that the command is inconsistent with physical state **325** (i.e., “No” in subprocess **350**), the command may be blocked in subprocess **370** and/or an alert may be issued in subprocess **380**.

(53) It should be understood that blocking the command means that the command is not executed. In this case, the command may be discarded, ignored, or delayed until a condition is satisfied. For example, in an implementation that delays execution of the command until a condition is satisfied, an alert may be provided to an operator in subprocess **380** (e.g., via a graphical user interface of SCADA/EMS **144** or other system, an email or text message, etc.), and the operator may be required to approve the command (e.g., via the graphical user interface of SCADA/EMS **144** or other system, a reply to the email or text message, etc.) before the command is executed. As another example, protection layer **155** may trigger a confirmation function in response to a determination that the command is inconsistent with physical state **325** (i.e., “No” in subprocess **350**), to confirm physical state **325** and/or the determined inconsistency. In this case, protection layer **155** may delay execution of the command until and unless confirmation is received from the confirmation function. This confirmation function may comprise requesting or awaiting confirmation from an external system, executing a higher fidelity detection algorithm to confirm a condition in power system **100** upon which the consistency assessment in subprocess **340** was based, and/or the like.

(54) 2.2. Consistency Assessment

(55) As discussed above, subprocess **340** of process **300** assesses whether or not a received command is consistent with physical state **325** of power system **100**. In particular, protection layer **155** may execute one or a plurality of security functions, and execute logic on the output of these security function(s) whenever the consistency of a command is assessed.

(56) FIG. 4 illustrates examples of the security functions **400** that may be employed by protection layer **155**, according to an embodiment. It should be understood that not all of the illustrated security functions **400** must be utilized in a particular embodiment. Rather, more, fewer, or a different combination of the illustrated security functions **400** and/or more, fewer, or a different combination of their constituent modules may be implemented by protection layer **155**. In an embodiment, security functions **400** comprise a line fault detection (LFD) function **410**, a system disturbance detection (SDD) function **420**, and/or an interlocking schemes (IS) function **430**. LFD function **410** determines whether or not a line fault exists within a detection zone, SDD function **420** determines whether or not a system disturbance exists within power system **100** (e.g., resulting from critical generation or transmission outages), and IS function **430** may determine loading on power line **110** and/or detect consecutive switching.

(57) LFD function **410** may comprise a current derivative module **412**, a directional module **414**, a zero sequence current module **416**, and/or the like. Current derivative module **412** may calculate the derivative of electrical current in power line **110**, for example, from consecutive measurements of the current by current measurement device(s) **116**. In general, a sudden rise in the current derivative (e.g., above a threshold) is indicative of a line fault. Directional module **414** may determine the direction of a fault on power line **110**, and zero sequence current module **416** may calculate the zero sequence current in power line **110**. Under normal system conditions, the zero sequence current in power line **110** is low and can be ignored. Thus, a sudden rise in the zero sequence current (e.g., above a threshold) is indicative of a line-to-ground fault. Overall, LFD

function **410** may determine whether or not a line fault exists in power line **110** within a detection zone (e.g., primary detection zone, for example, defined by a reach setting that specifies the portion of power line **110** that is covered by LFD function **410**), based on the outputs of current derivative module **412**, directional module **414**, zero sequence current module **416**, and/or the like. LFD function **410** may operate in real time as data is received and stored in the representation of physical state **325** of power system **100**, such that a present indication of whether or not a line fault exists in power line **110** is always readily available.

(58) The detection zone of LFD function **410** may be approximately 50%-80% of the length of power line **110**. LFD function **410** is generally not configured to cover the entire length of power line **110**, because: (i) the fault detection algorithms of LFD function **410** are typically based on local measurements, and therefore, are not able to distinguish remote faults at the end of power line **110** from external faults in the forward direction; and (ii) TRV issues are less severe for clearing a remote line fault.

(59) SDD function **420** may comprise an emergency power transfer detection module **422**, a frequency disturbance detection module **424**, an abnormal voltage detection module **426**, and/or the like. Emergency power transfer detection module **422** may determine whether or not there has been a transmission outage or emergency power transfer to or from power line **110** (e.g., by comparing the power flow in power line **110**, stored in physical state **325**, before and after reception of a command). It should be understood that an emergency power transfer is any transfer of power between power lines, resulting from an emergency (e.g., outage in another power line such as a direct-current link, outage in power line **110**, etc.). Frequency disturbance detection module **424** may determine whether or not a generation outage or frequency disturbance exists in power line **110** (e.g., by comparing the frequencies in power line **110**, stored in physical state **325**, before and after reception of a command). It should be understood that a frequency disturbance is any frequency in power line **110** that is abnormal or unexpected (e.g., a frequency above or below a threshold value, a rate of change of frequency above a threshold value, etc.). Abnormal voltage detection module **426** may determine whether or not an abnormal voltage exists in power line **110** (e.g., by comparing the voltage in power line **110**, stored in physical state **325**, before and after reception of a command). It should be understood that an abnormal voltage is any voltage in power line **110** that is abnormal or unexpected (e.g., a voltage above or below a threshold value). Overall, SDD function **420** may determine whether or not a system disturbance exists in power system **100** and/or what type of system disturbance exists in power system **100**. A system disturbance may be any one or combination of an emergency power transfer, frequency disturbance, abnormal voltage, and/or any other anomalous event on power line **110** whose existence and/or non-existence can be detected from the measurements received by controller **154**. SDD function **420** may operate in real time as data is received and stored in the representation of physical state **325** of power system **100**, such that a current indication of whether or not a system disturbance exists in power system **100** is always readily available. However, in an embodiment, SDD function **420** operates in response to reception of a command. In addition, the particular module(s) (e.g., **422**, **424**, or **426**) to be executed may be selected based on the command.

(60) IS function **430** may comprise a load detection module **432**, a consecutive switching detection module **434**, and/or the like. Load detection module **432** may detect the load on power line **110**. For example, the load may be characterized as low when it is below a first threshold, normal when it exceeds the first threshold and is below a second threshold, and high when it exceeds the second threshold. Consecutive switching detection module **434** may detect whether or not a command is received within a time window from execution of a prior command.

(61) It is assumed that any command **450** that is received by controller **154** may be malicious. Thus, protection layer **155** assesses each command **450** that is received. Whenever a command **450** is to be assessed (e.g., in subprocess **340** of process **300**), logic **440** may be executed with the output of security function(s) **400** and command **450** as inputs, to output a consistency assessment

determination **460** (e.g., to be used for the determination in subprocess **350** of whether to allow or block the command). Logic **440** may apply one or more rules to the output of security function(s) **400** and command **450** to render consistency assessment determination **460**.

(62) As an example, protection layer **155** may receive a command **450** to bypass SCB **151**, in a remote control signal purportedly sent from line protection system **130**. Logic **440** may access the indication of whether or not a line fault exists in the detection zone on power line **110**, most recently output by LFD function **410**, to determine whether or not a line fault exists. When command **450** is to bypass SCB **151** while no line fault is determined to exist within the detection zone by LFD function **410**, logic **440** may determine that command **450** is inconsistent with physical state **325** of power system **100** (e.g., “No” in subprocess **350** of process **300**). On the other hand, when command **450** is to bypass SCB **151** while a line fault is determined to exist within the detection zone by LFD function **410**, logic **440** may determine that command **450** is consistent with physical state **325** of power system **100** (e.g., “Yes” in subprocess **350** of process **300**).

(63) Notably, in an embodiment in which LFD function **410** operates in the background to determine whether or not a line fault exists in real time, logic **440** may determine the consistency of command **450** very quickly (e.g., within a few milliseconds from receipt of command **450**). This is because logic **440** is applying a rule to existing output from LFD function **410**, without having to calculate a new output from LFD function **410**. Thus, the disclosed embodiments ensure that fast bypassing of SCB **151** can be achieved when a line fault occurs, while simultaneously providing security against inconsistent and potentially malicious commands.

(64) As another example, protection layer **155** may receive a command **450** to insert SCB **151** in a remote control signal purportedly sent from a control system **140** (e.g., RAS system **142**, WAMPAC system **146**, etc.) in response to a major transmission outage. Logic **440** may acquire the output of emergency power transfer detection module **422** of SDD function **420**, which may be executed in response to reception of command **450** or by logic **440**. Emergency power transfer detection module **422** may examine power flow changes in power line **110** to determine whether or not an emergency power transfer to power line **110** exists within a time window around receipt of the remote control signal comprising command **450**. When command **450** is to insert SCB **151** and no emergency power transfer is determined to exist by SDD function **420** within the time window, logic **440** may determine that command **450** is inconsistent with physical state **325** of power system **100** (e.g., “No” in subprocess **350** of process **300**). On the other hand, when command **450** is to insert SCB **151** and an emergency power transfer is determined to exist by SDD function **420**, logic **440** may determine that command **450** is consistent with physical state **325** of power system **100** (e.g., “Yes” in subprocess **350** of process **300**).

(65) As another example, protection layer **155** may receive a command **450** to insert or bypass SCB **151** in a remote control signal purportedly sent from a control system **140** (e.g., RAS system **142**, WAMPAC system **146**, etc.) in response to a frequency disturbance. Logic **440** may acquire the output of frequency disturbance detection module **424** of SDD function **420**, which may be executed in response to reception of command **450** or by logic **440**. Frequency disturbance detection module **424** may analyze physical state **325** to determine whether or not a frequency disturbance exists within a time window around receipt of the remote control signal comprising command **450**. When command **450** is to one of insert SCB **151** or bypass SCB **151** and no frequency disturbance is determined to exist by SDD function **420** within the time window, logic **440** may determine that command **450** is inconsistent with physical state **325** of power system **100** (e.g., “No” in subprocess **350** of process **300**). On the other hand, when command **450** is to the other one of insert SCB **151** or bypass SCB **151** and the frequency disturbance is determined to exist by SDD function **420**, logic **440** may determine that command **450** is consistent with physical state **325** of power system **100** (e.g., “Yes” in subprocess **350** of process **300**). It should be understood that, whether a command **450** to insert SCB **151** or bypass SCB **151** is consistent with the frequency disturbance will depend on the particular frequency disturbance that is detected.

(66) As another example, protection layer **155** may receive a command **450** to insert or bypass SCB **151** in a remote control signal purportedly sent from a control system **140** (e.g., RAS system **142**, WAMPAC system **146**, etc.) in response to an abnormal voltage. Logic **440** may acquire the output of abnormal voltage detection module **426** of SDD function **420**, which may be executed in response to reception of command **450** or by logic **440**. Abnormal voltage detection module **426** may analyze physical state **325** to determine whether or not an abnormal voltage exists within a time window around receipt of the remote control signal comprising command **450**. When command **450** is to one of insert SCB **151** or bypass SCB **151** and no abnormal voltage is determined to exist by SDD function **420** within the time window, logic **440** may determine that command **450** is inconsistent with physical state **325** of power system **100** (e.g., “No” in subprocess **350** of process **300**). On the other hand, when command **450** is to the other one of insert SCB **151** or bypass SCB **151** and the abnormal voltage is determined to exist by SDD function **420**, logic **440** may determine that command **450** is consistent with physical state **325** of power system **100** (e.g., “Yes” in subprocess **350** of process **300**). It should be understood that, whether a command **450** to insert SCB **151** or bypass SCB **151** is consistent with the abnormal voltage will depend on the particular abnormality in voltage that is detected.

(67) Notably, in an embodiment in which SDD function **420** is executed in response to receiving a command **450**, the relevant modules (e.g., **422**, **424**, **426**, etc.) that are executed may be constrained to execute and produce an output within a time window from receiving the remote control signal comprising command **450**. Logic **440** may utilize whatever output is produced within the time window to determine the consistency of command **450** with physical state **325**. The time window may be a few hundred milliseconds (e.g., within 500 milliseconds) from reception of the remote control signal. This ensures that fast insertion or bypassing of SCB **151** can be achieved, to prevent damage to power system **100**.

(68) In an embodiment, SDD function **420** may be used as a defense against denial-of-service (DoS) attacks. In a DoS attack, the remote control command from a control system **140** (e.g., RAS system **142**) may be blocked or compromised by an attacker. For example, if an attacker successfully blocked an insertion command from RAS system **142**, during an abnormal line flow increase, this may lead to severe power swings in power line **110**. Power system **100** may become unstable if SCBs **151** are not quickly inserted. Thus, SDD function **420** may continuously monitor physical state **325** of power system **100**, and determine whether or not the dynamic conditions represented in physical state **325** satisfy a predefined condition, comprising one or more criteria indicative of a system disturbance. It should be understood that emergency power transfer detection module **422**, frequency disturbance detection module **424**, abnormal voltage detection module **426**, and/or other modules of SDD function **420** may each detect a predefined condition representing a different system disturbance. Whenever SDD function **420** detects a system disturbance or certain severe system disturbances, SDD function **420** may automatically issue an alarm (e.g., in the same or similar manner as in subprocess **380** of process **300**). Additionally or alternatively, whenever SDD function **420** detects a system disturbance or certain severe system disturbances, SDD function **420** may automatically initiate a fast insertion of SCB **151**. In particular, SDD function **420** may instruct controller **154** to open bypass breaker **152**.

(69) As another example, protection layer **155** may receive a command **450** to insert or bypass SCB **151** in a remote control signal purportedly sent from a control system **140** (e.g., SCADA/EMS **144**). Logic **440** may acquire the output of load detection module **432** of IS function **430**, which may be executed in response to reception of command **450** or by logic **440**. Load detection module **432** may analyze physical state **325** to determine the present load on power line **110**. When command **450** is to insert SCB **151** and the present load is below a first threshold, representing low load, logic **440** may determine that command **450** is inconsistent with physical state **325** of power system **100**. Likewise, when command **450** is to bypass SCB **151** and the present load exceeds a second threshold, representing high load, logic **440** may determine that command **450** is

inconsistent with physical state **325** of power system **100**. Bypassing SCB **151** under high load conditions may overload other parallel power lines. On the other hand, when command **450** is to insert SCB **151** and the present load exceeds the second threshold, representing high load, logic **440** may determine that command **450** is consistent with physical state **325** of power system **100**. Likewise, when command **450** is to bypass SCB **151** and the present load is below the first threshold, representing low load, logic **440** may determine that command **450** is consistent with physical state **325** of power system **100**. In principle, SCB **151** should be inserted under high load conditions and bypassed under low load conditions.

(70) As another example, protection layer **155** may receive a command **450** to insert or bypass SCB **151** in a remote control signal purportedly sent from a control system **140** (e.g., SCADA/EMS **144**). Logic **440** may acquire the output of consecutive switching detection module **434**, which may be executed in response to reception of command **450** or by logic **440**. Consecutive switching detection module **434** may determine whether present command **450** is received within a time window from execution of a prior command and represents a switch in the state of SCB **151** over the prior command. For example, when present command **450** is to insert SCB **151** and is received within the time window from execution of a prior command to bypass SCB **151**, logic **440** may determine that present command **450** is inconsistent with physical state **325** of power system **100**. Likewise, when present command **450** is to bypass SCB **151** and is received within the time window from execution of a prior command to insert SCB **151**, logic **440** may determine that present command **450** is inconsistent with physical state **325** of power system **100**. Consecutive switching between insertion and bypassing of SCB **151** within a short period of time may cause forced power swings, inter-area power oscillations, and instability in a poorly damped power system **100**. The time window may be set to an appropriate length of time to prevent these swings and instability in power system **100**, thereby blocking malicious switching commands.

(71) It should be understood that logic **440** may combine the outputs of two or more security functions **400** to produce consistency assessment determination **460**. In particular, logic **440** may apply rules that resolve conflicts between two or more security functions **400**. For example, if assessments of command **450** across all security functions **400** all result in a determination that command **450** is consistent with physical state **325**, consistency assessment determination **460** may be that command **450** is consistent with physical state **325**. Likewise, if assessments of command **450** across all security functions **400** all result in a determination that command **450** is inconsistent with physical state **325**, consistency assessment determination **460** may be that command **450** is inconsistent with physical state **325**. In an embodiment, if there are a mixture of determinations (i.e., one or more determinations of consistency and one or more determinations of inconsistency), logic **440** may apply rules to render a final consistency assessment determination **460**, such as always determining that command **450** is inconsistent with physical state **325**, choosing the consensus determination if there are three or more security functions **400**, prioritizing security functions **400** and selecting the determination of the security function **400** with the highest priority, weighting the security functions **400** and selecting the determination with the highest weight, or the like.

3. Example Scenarios

(72) The performance of disclosed embodiments with respect to example scenarios will now be described. It should be understood that these are non-limiting examples intended to illustrate the operation of disclosed embodiments, and are not a requirement of any embodiment.

(73) FIGS. 5A and 5B illustrate the status of a power system **100**, before and after a line fault, respectively, according to an example scenario. In the illustrated scenarios, power system **100** is a transmission system that transmits electricity along a transmission corridor between Region A and Region B. The transmission corridor consists of a high-voltage direct current (DC) link **160** and an AC link with two AC transmission lines **110A** and **110B**. Each AC transmission line **110A** and **110B** is series compensated by two SCB stations **150**. In particular, AC transmission line **110A**

comprises, in series from Region A to Region B, a circuit breaker **120A**, SCB station **150A**, SCB station **150B**, and circuit breaker **120B**. Similarly, AC transmission line **110B** comprises, in series from Region A to Region B, a circuit breaker **120C**, SCB station **150C**, SCB station **150D**, and circuit breaker **120D**.

(74) In the pre-fault condition, illustrated in FIG. 5A, the SCB **151** of each SCB station **150A-150D** is inserted (i.e., each respective bypass breaker **152** is in the open state), and all circuit breakers **120A-120D** are closed. Thus, both AC transmission lines **110A** and **110B** are being series-compensated. In the fault condition, a three-phase-to-ground fault occurs in the approximate middle of AC transmission line **110B**, such that it is within the detection zone of LFD function **410** for both SCB stations **150C** and **150D**. Line protection system **130** will issue a bypass command to SCB stations **150C** and **150D** on AC transmission line **110B**, and will open circuit breakers **120C** and **120D** on AC transmission line **110B**. As a result, in the post-fault condition, illustrated in FIG. 5B, the SCB **151** of each SCB station **150C** and **150D** on AC transmission line **110B** is bypassed (i.e., the respective bypass breakers **152** are switched to the closed state). Thereafter, circuit breakers **120C** and **120D** on AC transmission line **110B** are opened. Bypassing SCB **151**, prior to opening the corresponding circuit breaker **120**, in this manner, may mitigate transient recovery voltages. Notably, no changes occur on AC transmission line **110A**.

(75) FIG. 6 consists of four plots, along the same time line (in seconds), that illustrate the current for each of the three phases in AC transmission line **110B**, the output of LFD function **410** versus a remote control signal received from line protection system **130**, the position of bypass breaker **152**, and the position of circuit breaker **120** for each of the three phases in AC transmission line **110B**, respectively, representing the results of a simulation of the scenario illustrated in FIGS. 5A and 5B, according to an embodiment. Plot A in FIG. 6 illustrates the current of the three phases of AC transmission line **110B**.

(76) Plot B in FIG. 6 illustrates the time at which LFD function **410** detects the line fault, relative to the time at which a remote control signal, comprising a command to bypass SCB **151**, is received from line protection system **130**. A value of 0 represents the absence of a signal and the value of 1 represents the presence of a signal. As illustrated, LFD function **410** detects the line fault relatively quickly (i.e., within about 5 milliseconds from the occurrence of the line fault). Typically, line protection system **130** can detect a line fault within the detection zone within half-cycle time. The communication of the bypass command from line protection system **130** and SCB station **150** may add a communication delay (e.g., approximately 2 milliseconds). Thus, LFD function **410** detects the line fault before the remote control signal, comprising the bypass command, is received from line protection system **130**. Accordingly, since the line fault is already confirmed by the time that the bypass command is received, logic **440** can immediately determine that the bypass command is consistent with physical state **325** (i.e., “Yes” in subprocess **350** of process **300**), and controller **154** may quickly execute the bypass command (e.g., subprocess **360** of process **300**). It should be understood that Plot B may be representative of the operation of each SCB station **150C** and **150D**.

(77) Plots C and D in FIG. 6 represent the positions of a bypass breaker **152** on AC transmission line **110B** and the position of a circuit breaker **120** for each of the phases of AC transmission line **110B**, respectively. A value of 0 represents the closed state and a value of 1 represents the open state. As illustrated, due to the quick determination by protection layer **155**, bypass breaker **152** closes soon after the bypass command is received from line protection system **130**. Notably, circuit breaker **120** for phase C opens a half-cycle after circuit breakers **120** for phases A and B open, due to different current zero-cross moments. It should be understood that Plots C and D may be representative of the operation of each SCB station **150C** and **150D** and each circuit breaker **120C** and **120D**, respectively.

(78) Notably, in the scenario described above, the remote control signal was a valid signal that was determined to be consistent. In the event that the remote control signal from line protection system

130 was malicious, the signal from line fault detection module **410** would never indicate the existence of a line fault (i.e., would remain at a value of 0). Consequently, bypass breakers **152** on AC transmission line **110B** would remain open. In other words, logic **440** may determine that, when the signal from line fault detection module **410** and the signal from line protection system **130** both have a value of 1, then the command is consistent. Conversely, logic **440** may determine that, when the signal from line fault detection module **410** has a value of 0 and the signal from line protection system **130** has a value of 1, then the command is inconsistent. It should be understood that, when the signal from line protection system **130** has a value of 0, logic **440** may not execute, since this implies that no command has been received.

(79) FIGS. 7A and 7B illustrate the status of a power system **100**, before and after an emergency power transfer, respectively, according to an example scenario. The components of power system **100** in FIGS. 7A and 7B are the same as the components of power system **100** in FIGS. 5A and 5B, and therefore, will not be redundantly described herein.

(80) In the pre-transfer condition, illustrated in FIG. 7A, the SCB **151** of each SCB station **150A-150D** is bypassed (i.e., each respective bypass breaker **152** is in the closed state), and all circuit breakers **120A-120D** are closed. Thus, neither of AC transmission lines **110A** and **110B** are being series compensated. As illustrated in FIG. 7B, there is a forced outage of DC link **160**, which causes a severe system disturbance, resulting in an emergency power transfer to AC lines **110A** and **110B**. Consequently, RAS system **142** will issue an insertion command to SCB stations **150A-150D**, in order to effectively compensate the line inductive reactance of AC transmission lines **110A** and **110B**, and enhance the stability of power system **100** against high power swings. As a result, in the post-transfer condition, illustrated in FIG. 7B, the SCB **151** of each SCB station **150A-150D** is inserted (i.e., the respective bypass breakers **152** are switched to the open state). Circuit breakers **120A-120D** remain closed.

(81) FIG. 8 consists of three plots, along the same time line (in seconds), that illustrate the load on DC link **160** and the AC link consisting of power lines **110A** and **110B**, the output of SDD function **420** versus a remote control signal received from RAS system **142**, and the position of bypass breaker **152** for each of SCB stations **150A-150D**, respectively, representing the results of a simulation of the scenario illustrated in FIGS. 7A and 7B, according to an embodiment. Plot A in FIG. 8 illustrates the power flows on DC link **160** and the AC link, and depicts an outage on DC link **160** at a time of about 6 seconds along the time line.

(82) Plot B of FIG. 8 illustrates the time at which emergency power transfer detection module **422** of SDD function **420** detects the emergency power transfer, relative to the time at which a remote control signal, comprising a command to insert SCB **151**, is received from RAS system **142**. A value of 0 represents the absence of a signal and the value of 1 represents the presence of a signal. It is assumed in this scenario that the remote control signal is sent by RAS system **142** immediately upon occurrence of the outage on DC link **160**, without any time delay, but this may not be the case in practice. As illustrated, emergency power transfer detection module **422** detects the emergency power transfer relatively quickly (e.g., within 1 second) after the insertion command is received. Thus, logic **440** can quickly determine that the insertion command is consistent with physical state **325** (i.e., “Yes” in subprocess **350** of process **300**), and controller **154** may quickly execute the insertion command (e.g., subprocess **360** of process **300**). It should be understood that Plot B may be representative of the operation of each SCB station **150A-150D**.

(83) Plot C of FIG. 8 represents the positions of bypass breaker **152**, with a value of 0 representing the closed state and a value of 1 representing the open state. As illustrated, bypass breaker **152** opens immediately after emergency power transfer detection module **422** of SDD function **420** detects the emergency power transfer, which is soon after the insertion command is received from RAS system **142**. It should be understood that Plot C may be representative of the operation of each SCB station **150A-150D**.

(84) Notably, in the scenario described above, the remote control signal was a valid signal that was

determined to be consistent. In the event that the remote control signal from RAS system **142** was malicious, the signal from SDD function **420** would never indicate the existence of a system disturbance (i.e., would remain at a value of 0). Consequently, bypass breakers **152** of SCB stations **150A-150D** would remain closed. In other words, logic **440** may determine that, when the signal from emergency power transfer detection module **422** and the signal from RAS system **142** both have a value of 1, then the command is consistent. Conversely, logic **440** may determine that, when the signal from emergency power transfer detection module **422** has a value of 0 and the signal from RAS system **142** has a value of 1, then the command is inconsistent. It should be understood that, when the signal from RAS system **142** has a value of 0, logic **440** may not execute, since this implies that no command has been received.

4. Example Embodiments

(85) Power systems **100**, such as transmission systems, may comprise one or more SCBs **151** in one or more SCB stations **150** on one or more power lines **110**. Each SCB station **150** may be controlled by remote control signals sent by remote systems, such as line protection system **130** or one or more control systems **140**, to insert or bypass its respective SCB **151**, according to scheduled or emergency switching operations. For example, an SCB station **150** may receive commands from a system operator through a SCADA/EMS **144** for scheduled operations, receive fast bypass commands from a line protection system **130** for TRV reduction, receive fast bypass or insertion commands from system protection schemes (e.g., implemented in control system(s) **140**) as part of a stability enhancement strategy against critical generation or transmission outages, and/or the like.

(86) Hackers may gain access to communication channels in power system **100** and cause unauthorized or altered insertion commands or bypass commands to be sent to SCB stations **150**, in order to manipulate positions of SCB **151**. These malicious commands may cause deteriorated conditions and risk instability in power system **100**, potentially leading to the collapse of power system **100**. Thus, protection against malicious control of SCB **151** is deemed critical.

(87) In an embodiment, one or more, and potentially all, SCB stations **150** in a power system **100** may comprise a controller **154** that stores and executes a protection layer **155**. Protection layer **155** may intercept all commands to insert or bypass SCB **151** of SCB station **150**, received from a remote system (e.g., line protection system **130**, control system **140**, etc.), and assess whether or not the commands are consistent with a physical state **325** of power system **100**. The assessment may utilize local real-time measurements of voltages and currents that are monitored by controller **154**, one or more security functions **400** that detect one or more conditions in the real-time measurements, and logic **440** that applies one or more rules to the detected condition(s) and the commands. Based on this assessment, protection layer **155** may determine whether to execute a given command (e.g., in subprocess **360** of process **300**) or block the given command (e.g., in subprocess **370** of process **300**). In this manner, protection layer **155** may prevent cyberattacks that are intended to manipulate SCB positions in power lines **110**.

(88) Embodiments of protection layer **155** provide fast and reliable detection of line faults within a detection zone (e.g., primary detection zone) and system disturbances indicative of contingencies of concern. In addition, embodiments of protection layer **155** utilize efficient detection algorithms to detect conditions of concern based on local measurements, and logic **440** to apply one or more rules for assessing consistency of a command, which are readily implementable in controller **154** of an SCB station **150**. In addition, in an embodiment, SDD function **420** can be used as a defense against DoS attacks by initiating fast SCB bypass or insertion in the event that control commands (e.g., from RAS system **142**) are compromised or blocked by attackers. Protection layer **155** may also block unwanted control commands sent by remote systems that are malfunctioning.

(89) Embodiment 1: A method comprising using at least one hardware processor, within a controller of a series capacitor bank (SCB) station, to: receive a remote control signal from a system that is external to the SCB station, wherein the remote control signal represents a command

to either electrically insert the SCB into a power line within a power system or bypass the SCB; assess whether or not the command is consistent with a physical state of the power system; when the command is inconsistent with the physical state of the power system, block execution of the command by the controller; and, when the command is consistent with the physical state of the power system, allow execution of the command by the controller.

(90) Embodiment 2: The method of Embodiment 1, further comprising using the at least one hardware processor to, when the command is inconsistent with the physical state of the power system, initiate an alert to one or more recipients.

(91) Embodiment 3: The method of any preceding embodiment, further comprising using the at least one hardware processor to execute a line-fault detection (LFD) function that determines whether or not a line fault exists within a detection zone, wherein assessing whether or not the command is consistent with the physical state of the power system comprises: determining that the command is inconsistent with the physical state of the power system when the command is to bypass the SCB and is received while no line fault is determined to exist within the detection zone by the LFD function; and determining that the command is consistent with the physical state of the power system when the command is to bypass the SCB and is received while the line fault is determined to exist within the detection zone by the LFD function.

(92) Embodiment 4: The method of Embodiment 3, wherein the remote control signal is received from a line protection system.

(93) Embodiment 5: The method of any preceding embodiment, further comprising using the at least one hardware processor to execute a system disturbance detection (SDD) function that determines whether or not a system disturbance exists within the power system, wherein assessing whether or not the command is consistent with the physical state of the power system comprises determining whether or not the command is consistent based on an existence or non-existence of the system disturbance, as determined by the SDD function, within a time window around receipt of the remote control signal.

(94) Embodiment 6: The method of Embodiment 5, wherein the system disturbance comprises an emergency power transfer, and wherein determining whether or not the command is consistent based on the existence or non-existence of the system disturbance comprises: determining that the command is inconsistent when the command is to insert the SCB and no emergency power transfer is determined to exist by the SDD function within the time window; and determining that the command is consistent when the command is to insert the SCB and the emergency power transfer is determined to exist by the SDD function within the time window.

(95) Embodiment 7: The method of Embodiment 5 or 6, wherein the system disturbance comprises a frequency disturbance, and wherein determining whether or not the command is consistent based on the existence or non-existence of the system disturbance comprises: determining that the command is inconsistent when the command is to one of insert the SCB or bypass the SCB and no frequency disturbance is determined to exist by the SDD function within the time window; and determining that the command is consistent when the command is to the other one of insert the SCB or bypass the SCB and the frequency disturbance is determined to exist by the SDD function within the time window.

(96) Embodiment 8: The method of any one of Embodiments 5 through 7, wherein the system disturbance comprises an abnormal voltage, and wherein determining whether or not the command is consistent based on the existence or non-existence of the system disturbance comprises: determining that the command is inconsistent when the command is to one of insert the SCB or bypass the SCB and no abnormal voltage is determined to exist by the SDD function within the time window; and determining that the command is consistent when the command is to the other one of insert the SCB or bypass the SCB and the abnormal voltage is determined to exist by the SDD function within the time window.

(97) Embodiment 9: The method of any one of Embodiments 5 through 8, wherein the remote

control signal is received from a remedial action schemes (RAS) system, an energy management system (EMS), or a wide-area monitoring, protection, and control (WAMPAC) system.

(98) Embodiment 10: The method of any preceding embodiment, wherein assessing whether or not the command is consistent with the physical state of the power system comprises: determining that the command is inconsistent with the physical state of the power system, when either the command is to insert the SCB and a present load of the transmission line is below a first threshold, or the command is to bypass the SCB and the present load of the transmission line exceeds a second threshold; and determining that the command is consistent with the physical state of the power system, when either the command is to insert the SCB and the present load of the transmission line exceeds the second threshold, or the command is to bypass the SCB and the present load of the transmission line is below the first threshold.

(99) Embodiment 11: The method of any preceding embodiment, wherein assessing whether or not the command is consistent with the physical state of the power system comprises determining that the command is inconsistent with the physical state of the power system when either: the command is to insert the SCB and is received within a time window from execution of a prior command to bypass the SCB; or the command is to bypass the SCB and is received within the time window from execution of a prior command to insert the SCB.

(100) Embodiment 12: The method of Embodiment 11, wherein the remote control signal is received from a remedial action schemes (RAS) system, an energy management system (EMS), or a wide area monitoring, protection, and control (WAMPAC) system.

(101) Embodiment 13: The method of any preceding embodiment, further comprising using the at least one hardware processor to execute two or more of: a line fault detection (LFD) function that determines whether or not a line fault exists on the transmission line; a system disturbance detection (SDD) function that determines whether or not a system disturbance exists within the power system; or an interlocking schemes (IS) function that determines one or both of a load condition of the transmission line or whether or not a prior command has been executed within a time window preceding receipt of the remote control signal; wherein assessing whether or not the command is consistent with the physical state of the power system comprises executing logic that utilizes the determination by each of the two or more of the LFD function, the SDD function, and the IS function to determine whether or not the command is consistent with the physical state of the power system.

(102) Embodiment 14: The method of Embodiment 13, further comprising using the at least one hardware processor to: receive real-time measurements of the power system; and execute the two or more of the LFD function, the SDD function, or the IS function in real time using the real-time measurements as input.

(103) Embodiment 15: The method of Embodiment 14, wherein the logic completes execution within 500 milliseconds of receiving the remote control signal.

(104) Embodiment 16: The method of any preceding embodiment, further comprising using the at least one hardware processor to: receive real-time measurements of the power system; and continually determine the physical state of the power system in real time based on the real-time measurements, wherein the assessment is performed each time a remote control signal is received.

(105) Embodiment 17: The method of any preceding embodiment, further comprising using the at least one hardware processor to, when execution of the command is allowed, controlling a bypass breaker of the SCB station according to the command.

(106) Embodiment 18: The method of Embodiment 17, wherein controlling the bypass breaker comprises: opening the bypass breaker when the command is to insert the SCB; and closing the bypass breaker when the command is to bypass the SCB.

(107) Embodiment 19: A series capacitor bank (SCB) station comprising: an SCB that includes a bank of capacitors arranged in series along a transmission line within a power system; a bypass breaker; and a controller that includes software representing a local protection layer, and at least

one hardware processor configured to execute the software to execute the method of any one of Embodiments 1 through 18.

(108) Embodiment 20: A non-transitory computer-readable medium having instructions stored thereon, wherein the instructions, when executed by a processor of a series capacitor bank (SCB) station, cause the processor to execute the method of any one of Embodiments 1 through 18.

(109) The above description of the disclosed embodiments is provided to enable any person skilled in the art to make or use the invention. Various modifications to these embodiments will be readily apparent to those skilled in the art, and the general principles described herein can be applied to other embodiments without departing from the spirit or scope of the invention. Thus, it is to be understood that the description and drawings presented herein represent a presently preferred embodiment of the invention and are therefore representative of the subject matter which is broadly contemplated by the present invention. It is further understood that the scope of the present invention fully encompasses other embodiments that may become obvious to those skilled in the art and that the scope of the present invention is accordingly not limited.

(110) Combinations, described herein, such as “at least one of A, B, or C,” “one or more of A, B, or C,” “at least one of A, B, and C,” “one or more of A, B, and C,” and “A, B, C, or any combination thereof” include any combination of A, B, and/or C, and may include multiples of A, multiples of B, or multiples of C. Specifically, combinations such as “at least one of A, B, or C,” “one or more of A, B, or C,” “at least one of A, B, and C,” “one or more of A, B, and C,” and “A, B, C, or any combination thereof” may be A only, B only, C only, A and B, A and C, B and C, or A and B and C, and any such combination may contain one or more members of its constituents A, B, and/or C. For example, a combination of A and B may comprise one A and multiple B's, multiple A's and one B, or multiple A's and multiple B's.

Claims

1. A method comprising using at least one hardware processor, within a controller of a series capacitor bank (SCB) station, to: receive a remote control signal from a system that is external to the SCB station, wherein the remote control signal represents a command to either electrically insert the SCB into a power line within a power system or bypass the SCB; execute a line-fault detection (LFD) function that determines whether or not a line fault exists within a detection zone; assess whether or not the command is consistent with a physical state of the power system, wherein assessing whether or not the command is consistent with the physical state of the power system comprises determining that the command is inconsistent with the physical state of the power system when the command is to bypass the SCB and is received while no line fault is determined to exist within the detection zone by the LFD function, and determining that the command is consistent with the physical state of the power system when the command is to bypass the SCB and is received while the line fault is determined to exist within the detection zone by the LFD function; when the command is inconsistent with the physical state of the power system, block execution of the command by the controller; and, when the command is consistent with the physical state of the power system, allow execution of the command by the controller.

2. The method of claim 1, further comprising using the at least one hardware processor to, when the command is inconsistent with the physical state of the power system, initiate an alert to one or more recipients.

3. The method of claim 1, wherein the remote control signal is received from a line protection system.

4. The method of claim 1, further comprising using the at least one hardware processor to execute a system disturbance detection (SDD) function that determines whether or not a system disturbance exists within the power system, wherein assessing whether or not the command is consistent with the physical state of the power system comprises determining whether or not the command is

- consistent based on an existence or non-existence of the system disturbance, as determined by the SDD function, within a time window around receipt of the remote control signal.
5. The method of claim 4, wherein the system disturbance comprises an emergency power transfer, and wherein determining whether or not the command is consistent based on the existence or non-existence of the system disturbance comprises: determining that the command is inconsistent when the command is to insert the SCB and no emergency power transfer is determined to exist by the SDD function within the time window; and determining that the command is consistent when the command is to insert the SCB and the emergency power transfer is determined to exist by the SDD function within the time window.
6. The method of claim 4, wherein the system disturbance comprises a frequency disturbance, and wherein determining whether or not the command is consistent based on the existence or non-existence of the system disturbance comprises: determining that the command is inconsistent when the command is to one of insert the SCB or bypass the SCB and no frequency disturbance is determined to exist by the SDD function within the time window; and determining that the command is consistent when the command is to the other one of insert the SCB or bypass the SCB and the frequency disturbance is determined to exist by the SDD function within the time window.
7. The method of claim 4, wherein the system disturbance comprises an abnormal voltage, and wherein determining whether or not the command is consistent based on the existence or non-existence of the system disturbance comprises: determining that the command is inconsistent when the command is to one of insert the SCB or bypass the SCB and no abnormal voltage is determined to exist by the SDD function within the time window; and determining that the command is consistent when the command is to the other one of insert the SCB or bypass the SCB and the abnormal voltage is determined to exist by the SDD function within the time window.
8. The method of claim 4, wherein the remote control signal is received from a remedial action schemes (RAS) system, an energy management system (EMS), or a wide-area monitoring, protection, and control (WAMPAC) system.
9. The method of claim 1, wherein assessing whether or not the command is consistent with the physical state of the power system comprises: determining that the command is inconsistent with the physical state of the power system, when either the command is to insert the SCB and a present load of the transmission line is below a first threshold, or the command is to bypass the SCB and the present load of the transmission line exceeds a second threshold; and determining that the command is consistent with the physical state of the power system, when either the command is to insert the SCB and the present load of the transmission line exceeds the second threshold, or the command is to bypass the SCB and the present load of the transmission line is below the first threshold.
10. The method of claim 1, further comprising using the at least one hardware processor to execute one or more of: a system disturbance detection (SDD) function that determines whether or not a system disturbance exists within the power system; or an interlocking schemes (IS) function that determines one or both of a load condition of the transmission line or whether or not a prior command has been executed within a time window preceding receipt of the remote control signal; wherein assessing whether or not the command is consistent with the physical state of the power system comprises executing logic that utilizes the determination by the LFD function and each of the one or more of the SDD function and the IS function to determine whether or not the command is consistent with the physical state of the power system.
11. The method of claim 10, further comprising using the at least one hardware processor to: receive real-time measurements of the power system; and execute the LFD function and the one or more of the LFD function, the SDD function or the IS function in real time using the real-time measurements as input.
12. The method of claim 11, wherein the logic completes execution within 500 milliseconds of receiving the remote control signal.

13. The method of claim 1, further comprising using the at least one hardware processor to: receive real-time measurements of the power system; and continually determine the physical state of the power system in real time based on the real-time measurements, wherein the assessment is performed each time a remote control signal is received.

14. The method of claim 1, further comprising using the at least one hardware processor to, when execution of the command is allowed, controlling a bypass breaker of the SCB station according to the command.

15. The method of claim 14, wherein controlling the bypass breaker comprises: opening the bypass breaker when the command is to insert the SCB; and closing the bypass breaker when the command is to bypass the SCB.

16. A method comprising using at least one hardware processor, within a controller of a series capacitor bank (SCB) station, to: receive a remote control signal from a system that is external to the SCB station, wherein the remote control signal represents a command to either electrically insert the SCB into a power line within a power system or bypass the SCB; assess whether or not the command is consistent with a physical state of the power system, wherein assessing whether or not the command is consistent with the physical state of the power system comprises determining that the command is inconsistent with the physical state of the power system when either the command is to insert the SCB and is received within a time window from execution of a prior command to bypass the SCB, or the command is to bypass the SCB and is received within the time window from execution of a prior command to insert the SCB; when the command is inconsistent with the physical state of the power system, block execution of the command by the controller; and, when the command is consistent with the physical state of the power system, allow execution of the command by the controller.

17. The method of claim 16, wherein the remote control signal is received from a remedial action schemes (RAS) system, an energy management system (EMS), or a wide area monitoring, protection, and control (WAMPAC) system.

18. A series capacitor bank (SCB) station comprising: an SCB that includes a bank of capacitors arranged in series along a transmission line within a power system; a bypass breaker; and a controller that includes software representing a local protection layer, and at least one hardware processor configured to execute the software to receive a remote control signal from a system that is external to the SCB station, wherein the remote control signal represents a command to either electrically insert the SCB into the transmission line by opening the bypass breaker or bypass the SCB by closing the bypass breaker; execute a line-fault detection (LFD) function that determines whether or not a line fault exists within a detection zone, assess whether or not the command is consistent with a physical state of the power system, wherein assessing whether or not the command is consistent with the physical state of the power system comprises determining that the command is inconsistent with the physical state of the power system when the command is to bypass the SCB and is received while no line fault is determined to exist within the detection zone by the LFD function, and determining that the command is consistent with the physical state of the power system when the command is to bypass the SCB and is received while the line fault is determined to exist within the detection zone by the LFD function; when the command is inconsistent with the physical state of the power system, block execution of the command; and, when the command is consistent with the physical state of the power system, execute the command.

19. A non-transitory computer-readable medium having instructions stored thereon, wherein the instructions, when executed by a processor of a series capacitor bank (SCB) station, cause the processor to: receive a remote control signal from a system that is external to the SCB station, wherein the remote control signal represents a command to either electrically insert the SCB into a transmission line within a power system or bypass the SCB; execute a line-fault detection (LFD) function that determines whether or not a line fault exists within a detection zone; assess whether or

not the command is consistent with a physical state of the power system, wherein assessing whether or not the command is consistent with the physical state of the power system comprises determining that the command is inconsistent with the physical state of the power system when the command is to bypass the SCB and is received while no line fault is determined to exist within the detection zone by the LFD function, and determining that the command is consistent with the physical state of the power system when the command is to bypass the SCB and is received while the line fault is determined to exist within the detection zone by the LFD function; when the command is inconsistent with the physical state of the power system, block execution of the command by the controller; and, when the command is consistent with the physical state of the power system, allow execution of the command by the controller.
